Guitar Exercises — Section XI, Level 84

Complete Solo-Guitar Arrangement Capstone

Independent Melody • Walking Bass • Inner Voices • Reharmonization • Dynamics • Uninterrupted Performance

Level 84 of 105. This completes Section XI. HARD STOP after Level 105.

Voice priority: **melody** → **bass destination** → **guide tones** → **chord body** → **optional color.** If the arrangement overloads, remove voices in reverse order.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Melody/bass skeleton extraction	128
B	Guide-tone insertion and inner-voice economy	128
C	Walking-bass and pedal-tone integration	144
D	Reharmonization and substitution choices	128
E	Texture, register, and dynamic orchestration	128
F	Section transitions and cadence design	112
G	Reduction, recovery, and no-restart drills	96
H	Four 8-bar arrangement studies	192
I	32-bar complete solo-guitar capstone	256
J	Performance audit and alternate arrangement	96
	TOTAL	1408

Capstone rule: no restart. Recover by reducing to melody + structural bass, locate the next cadence, then rebuild texture.

Module A — Melody/Bass Skeleton

Before any chord-melody voicing is chosen, sing the melody and play the bass separately. Then combine only the two outer voices.

Cell	Bass	Top melody	Task
1	C-B-A-G	E-E-C-B	contrary/oblique control
2	F-F#-G-C	A-A-B-E	passing diminished approach
3	A-G-F-E	C-B-A-G#	minor descending bass
4	D-D#-E-A	F-F#-G#-C	chromatic destination approach
5	C-E-F-G	G-G-A-B	ascending bass under repeated contour
6	A-C-D-E	E-E-F-G#	minor cadence preparation

Passes: melody alone → bass alone → sing melody while playing bass → play both → transpose one cell.

Module B — Guide-Tone Insertion

Add only the smallest inner motion required to identify harmony. Do not fill every available string.

Progression	Outer voices	Inner guide motion
Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	bass C-A-D-G; melody E-C-F-B	B-C-C-B
Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7	C-A-D-G; E-C#-F-B	B-G-C-F
Am7-Dm7-E7-AmMaj7	A-D-E-A; C-F-G#-G#	G-C-D-E
Gmaj7-B7-Em7-A7	G-B-E-A; B-D#-G-C#	F#-A-D-G

Reduction test: remove the guide tone. If the harmony remains clear, it is optional; if quality disappears, restore it.

Module C — Walking Bass and Pedal Integration

Study	Bass design	Upper-voice rule
C major walk	C-B-A-G | F-F#-G-C	melody remains legato
A minor walk	A-G-F-E | D-D#-E-A	G# must define E7
High-E pedal	C-E-F-G bass	top E stays fixed
G pedal	C-Bb-A-G bass	top G stays fixed
Anticipated bass	approach next root on & of 4	chord waits until beat 1
Anticipated chord	bass waits for beat 1	upper shell enters on & of 4

Never allow a chromatic approach to become more prominent than the destination root.

Module D — Reharmonization Choices

Baseline	Alternative	Reason
Cmaj7 → Am7	Cmaj7 → A7 → Dm7	secondary dominant creates forward motion
Fmaj7 → G7	Fmaj7 → F#dim7 → G7	chromatic connector
Gmaj7 → Em7	Gmaj7 → B7 → Em7	dominantizes vi
Am7 → Dm7	Am7 → A7 → Dm7	dominantizes iv
Cmaj7 → G7	Cmaj7 → Db7 → Cmaj7/G	chromatic color / bass approach
Dm7 → G7 → C	Dm7 → Ab7 → G7 → C	brief dominant color; preserve melody

For every substitution: sing fixed melody → state destination → play bass only → add guide tones → add complete voicing.

Module E — Texture, Register, and Dynamic Architecture

Section role	Texture	Register	Dynamic
Opening	melody + sparse bass	middle	p
Statement	bass + melody + guide tone	middle	mp
Development	walking bass + fuller voicings	low/middle	mf
Climax	spread/drop-2 voicings	wide	f
Release	bass + melody only	upper	mp
Ending	single bass + sustained melody/chord	wide then decay	pp

Play the same eight bars six times, changing only the assigned orchestration variable. Harmony and melody remain fixed.

Module F — Section Transitions and Cadence Design

Transition	Last-bar device	Destination
A → B	walking bass C-C#-D	Dm7
B → C	F-F#-G bass	G7 / new section
Major → relative minor	B7 guide tone D#	Em
Minor → major	Dm7-G7	Cmaj7
Build → climax	pedal top note + rising bass	spread tonic voicing
Climax → release	resolve melody early; bass alone on beat 4	sparse next section

Loop last bar + first bar only. A successful transition arrives with correct chord, bass, melody, register, dynamic, and role.

Module G — Reduction and No-Restart Recovery

Failure	Immediate repair
Melody lost	remove inner voices; sing next melody target
Bass late	root only on next beat 1
Chord too large	reduce to shell + melody
Chromatic walk fails	jump directly to destination root
Substitution forgotten	return to baseline harmony
Guide tone wrong	remove it; preserve outer voices
Form lost	melody landmarks + roots until cadence
Hand cannot reach voicing	use nearest triad/inversion

Practice every failure deliberately. Recovery is part of the arrangement, not an exception to it.

Module H — Study 1 — C-major ballad

| Cmaj7 | Cmaj7/B | Am7 | G7 | Fmaj7 | F#dim7 | G7 | Cmaj7 |

Melody: E E C B | A A B E. Walking bass; one passing diminished.

Pass	Requirement
1	melody only
2	bass only
3	bass + melody
4	add guide tones
5	full arrangement
6	alternate reharmonization with melody unchanged

Record pass 5. Then perform pass 6 without looking at pass 5's voicing choices.

Module H — Study 2 — A-minor color

| Am7 | G7 | Fmaj7 | E7 | Am7 | Dm7 | E7 | AmMaj7 |

Melody: C B A G# | C F G# G#. Preserve dominant leading tone.

Pass	Requirement
1	melody only
2	bass only
3	bass + melody
4	add guide tones
5	full arrangement
6	alternate reharmonization with melody unchanged

Record pass 5. Then perform pass 6 without looking at pass 5's voicing choices.

Module H — Study 3 — Secondary dominants

| Cmaj7 | A7 | Dm7 | G7 | Em7 | A7 | Dm7 | G7 |

Melody: E C# F B | G C# F B. Use compact guide-tone motion.

Pass	Requirement
1	melody only
2	bass only
3	bass + melody
4	add guide tones
5	full arrangement
6	alternate reharmonization with melody unchanged

Record pass 5. Then perform pass 6 without looking at pass 5's voicing choices.

Module H — Study 4 — Register orchestration

| Cmaj7 | Am7 | Dm7 | G7 | Cmaj7 | A7 | Dm7 | G7 |

Bars 1-2 sparse, 3-4 middle, 5-6 spread, 7-8 reduction.

Pass	Requirement
1	melody only
2	bass only
3	bass + melody
4	add guide tones
5	full arrangement
6	alternate reharmonization with melody unchanged

Record pass 5. Then perform pass 6 without looking at pass 5's voicing choices.

Module I — 32-Bar Complete Solo-Guitar Capstone (Bars 1–16)

Bar	Harmony	Melody target	Bass
1	Cmaj7	E	C
2	Cmaj7/B	E	B
3	Am7	C	A
4	G7	B	G
5	Fmaj7	A	F
6	F#dim7	A	F#
7	G7	B	G
8	Cmaj7	E	C
9	Am7	C	A
10	G7	B	G
11	Fmaj7	A	F
12	E7	G#	E
13	Am7	C	A
14	Dm7	F	D
15	E7	G#	E
16	AmMaj7	G#	A

Each bar: establish melody target; land structural bass; add only enough inner harmony to identify the chord. Use walking approaches only when the next bass destination is secure.

Module I — 32-Bar Complete Solo-Guitar Capstone (Bars 17–32)

Bar	Harmony	Melody target	Bass
17	Dm7	F	D
18	D#dim7	F#	D#
19	Em7	G	E
20	A7	C#	A
21	Dm7	F	D
22	G7	B	G
23	Cmaj7	E	C
24	Cmaj7	G	C
25	Cmaj7	E	C
26	A7	C#	A
27	Dm7	F	D
28	G7	B	G
29	Cmaj7	G	C
30	F#dim7	A	F#
31	G7	B	G
32	C6/9	D	C

Each bar: establish melody target; land structural bass; add only enough inner harmony to identify the chord. Use walking approaches only when the next bass destination is secure.

Module J — Section XI Completion Audit

Perform the 32-bar arrangement twice: first as the printed baseline, then as an alternate arrangement with at least six changed voicings/substitutions while the melody and form remain unchanged.

Category	0	1	2
Melody clarity	lost	functional	dominant
Bass independence	lost	functional	confident
Guide-tone accuracy	wrong	mostly	smooth
Reharmonization	random	plausible	purposeful
Voice balance	collapsed	usable	controlled
Dynamic architecture	flat	some contrast	clear arc
Form/pulse	lost	recovers	stable
Recovery	restart	simplifies	seamless

Pass Section XI: 14/16 or better on two separate days, with no zero in melody clarity, bass independence, form/pulse, or recovery.

NEXT: Level 85 begins Section XII — Groove & Stylistic Rhythm. Fixed roadmap remains Levels 85–90 groove, 91–94 expression, 95–99 repertoire, 100–104 composition, 105 final capstone. HARD STOP after Level 105.